DHAKADRIVE-VQA · PLAN FOR TEAM REVIEW

Annotation Platform Plan

Moving the benchmark tool from two laptops to one shared website with logins

12 October 2026 · **Draft — three decisions still open (last page)**

1 At a glance

WHERE IT LIVES

A website on a **triips.org subdomain**, hosted on our cPanel. Everyone signs in with **Google**. All data sits in one shared **Supabase** database, so the laptop syncing and partner copies go away.

WHO USES IT

Annotators write questions and answer other people's. **Admins** also manage users, the taxonomy and the models, settle flagged questions, and see the statistics.

HOW A QUESTION IS ACCEPTED

The setter's answer plus **two independent blind answers**. If all three agree, it's accepted. If not, it's **flagged** for review.

COST

Free to start. Supabase Free and our existing cPanel are enough for a long while. Later we'd likely move to Supabase Pro (US$25/month) as the dataset grows.

The current 36 questions were demo data and won't be carried over. The new site starts empty.

2 Who can do what

ROLE	CAN DO
New sign-in	Waits for an admin to approve them, and sees nothing until then. Anyone can sign in with Google, but only approved people see data.
Annotator	Uploads scenes and writes questions with their own answer. Answers questions written by others, from a queue. Sees how their own questions turned out.
Admin	Everything annotators can do, plus: approve users and set roles; edit the taxonomy, models and settings; record or import model answers and grade them; settle flagged questions; see the statistics; export the dataset.

3 How a question gets accepted

This applies to **Context/consensus (C)** and **Inferential (I)** questions. It's how we get a defensible answer for questions where people could reasonably read the scene differently.

STEP 1
Setter writes it
The question plus their own answer, which is required. The answer **locks** once anyone else answers, so it can't be changed to match them.

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STEP 2
Two others answer blind
Never the setter, and each person once. Before answering they can't see the setter's answer, each other's, or any model's.

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STEP 3
Compare all three
Yes/no, multiple-choice, multi-select and number answers are compared **automatically**. For written answers, each grounder marks whether theirs means the same as the setter's.

All three agree → accepted
That answer becomes the official answer that models are scored against.

Any disagreement → flagged
It goes to the admin review queue and is left out of model scoring until an admin accepts an answer, sends it back for rewriting, or drops it.

- **Flags are data, not just problems.** The share of questions where all three agreed, per category and type, is the inter-annotator agreement our proposal says we will report.
- **No double-booking.** The queue reserves the two answer slots, so a third person can't answer at the same moment.
- **Team size:** each question needs two people besides its author, so **three active annotators** is the minimum.
- **Admins who have opened a question's answer** are kept out of answering it themselves.

4 What admins can change

The whole taxonomy lives in the database and is edited from admin pages. No code changes are needed.

- **Categories** (today's six "dimensions"): add, rename, reorder, hide.
- **Fine-grained types** (today's 27): name, example, which category, and defaults for verifiability, modality, probes, answer format and the ★ regional mark.
- **Verifiability levels** (V / C / I), including how many independent answers each needs.
- **Grounding probes, modalities and diagnostic axes** (viewpoint, density, sensing condition, ontology, reasoning depth) with their values.
- **Models** being benchmarked, and their answers.
- **Answer formats:** names and descriptions only. A new format needs code, because each one has its own way of being compared.

> **Safe edits.** A question keeps the settings it was written with, so editing a type never silently changes questions that are already answered. Anything that's been used can be hidden but not deleted, and every change is logged.

5 How it's built

Your browser
Annotators and admins, signed in with Google.

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Website on cPanel
Plain files only, so there's no server process to crash or maintain.

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Supabase
- Google sign-in
- The database (questions, answers, taxonomy)
- Scene images, stored privately
- All permission rules

- **Rules are enforced inside the database**, not just in the website. Even someone poking around in their browser can't see an answer before they've given their own.
- **DNS:** triips.org itself runs on Vercel behind Cloudflare, so the subdomain needs its own DNS record pointing at the cPanel server.
- **Updates deploy automatically:** pushing to GitHub rebuilds the site and uploads it to cPanel.

6 Storage and cost

Images are the bulk of the data. Converting uploads to WebP at full resolution makes each scene about **7× smaller**. We checked bus-board text and road signs at 2× zoom and saw no visible difference.

PER SCENE IMAGE (1920×1080)	SIZE	SCENES PER 1 GB
As uploaded today (PNG)	≈ 2,090 KB	≈ 500
Converted (WebP, quality 90)	≈ 285 KB	≈ 3,700

OPTION	WHAT WE GET	VERDICT
Supabase Free	500 MB database, 1 GB images (≈ 3,700 scenes, or 185k–330k questions). No automatic backups, and it pauses after a week with no activity.	**Start here.** A nightly job copies the database and images to cPanel as our backup.
Supabase Pro US$25 / month	8 GB database, 100 GB images, daily database backups, never pauses.	**Move here** when storage nears 800 MB, we add video clips, or the database fills with model answers.
Bigger cPanel plan (5 GB)	Space for images only. It would need an extra login-checking script on cPanel to keep images private.	**Not needed.** The database will need Pro at full scale anyway, and Pro includes image space.

7 Build order

1. **Database and rules.** Tables, permissions, the accept/flag logic and the starting taxonomy. Automated tests check the rules that must never break: blind answering, setters not answering their own questions, no third answer, and correct accept/flag outcomes.
2. **Website.**
   - Sign-in and waiting-for-approval pages.
   - For annotators: a dashboard, writing questions for a scene, the answer queue (with a zoomable image), and "my questions".
   - For admins: users, taxonomy editor, models, settings, the flagged-question queue, statistics, and dataset export/import.
3. **Go live.** Deploy to the subdomain, switch on the nightly backup, and run a real test: one setter and two annotators take one question that agrees and one that gets flagged.

+ **Later, from the proposal (not needed to launch):** scene graphs (agents and yield/conflict/follow/block links), drawing boxes and ranking items as answers, bulk import of template-generated questions for checking, a sealed test split, and video clips.

8 Decisions still open

1. Verifiable (V) questions: how many independent answers?
Proposed: the setter + 1. These are readable straight from the image, so one check is usually enough. Setting it to the setter + 2 (the same as C and I) doubles the answering work on V questions. It's one setting either way.

2. Written answers: who decides whether they mean the same thing?
Proposed: each grounder, right after submitting, comparing against the setter's answer. The alternatives are the setter or an admin, but the setter has a stake in the outcome and admins would become a bottleneck.

3. Setup details
The subdomain name (for example *vqa.triips.org*) and which Google account becomes the first admin.

Setup only the account owner can do

- Create the Supabase project.
- Create a Google sign-in client (in Google Cloud).
- Add the subdomain in cPanel and its DNS record.
- Give the deploy job the cPanel FTP login.

Step-by-step instructions will be provided for each.

Based on the DhakaDrive-VQA research proposal (§4.4 diagnostic axes, §4.5 annotation workflow), the BUET thesis proposal, and the current benchmark tool.